Conversation track 22, 24, 25

Lam rents a house from Ingrid. She wants to raise the rent next year, so they're negotiating.

Ingrid: Lam, I'm afraid I'll have to raise your rent by ten percent next year.

Lam: Ten percent? That's quite steep. **What if** I **signed** for two years instead?

Ingrid: That would help. I could probably do seven, then.

Lam: I was rather hoping for three. Could we **meet halfway** at five?

Ingrid: You drive a hard bargain! Five it is, **as long as** you mow the lawn.

Lam: Happy to, **provided that** the boiler gets fixed before winter.

Ingrid: That's reasonable. I'll have it looked at on Monday.

Lam: Brilliant. Then I think we've got a deal.

Study Notes

You drive a hard bargain!
Anh mặc cả giỏi thật đấy!
Nói khi đối phương thương lượng cứng rắn, khó nhượng bộ; thường nửa đùa nửa thật.
Cách nói tương đương: You're a tough negotiator!

Five it is.
Vậy chốt năm phần trăm nhé.
"… it is" dùng để chốt một lựa chọn sau khi bàn bạc.
Cách nói tương đương: OK, let's go with five.

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. What if I signed for two years instead?
linking: "What‿if‿I"
weak: "for"
strong: "two years", "instead"
"What if I" nối thành "wo-ti-phai" (giọng Anh giữ /t/; giọng Mỹ đọc "wa-đi-phai"). "for" đọc nhẹ /fə/. Lên giọng nhẹ ở cuối: đề xuất mang tính thăm dò.

2. Could we meet halfway at five?
weak: "Could we"
strong: "halfway", "five"
Chữ "l" trong "half" câm: giọng Anh đọc /ˌhɑːfˈweɪ/ "haaf-wây", giọng Mỹ /ˌhæfˈweɪ/ "hép-wây". Nhấn "five": con số mình đề xuất.

3. Happy to, provided that the boiler gets fixed before winter.
weak: "that"
change: "fixed" (đuôi -ed đọc /t/)
strong: "boiler", "winter"
Ngắt nhẹ sau "Happy to". "that" đọc nhẹ /ðət/; "fixed" đọc /fɪkst/. Giọng Anh: "winter" "win-tơ"; giọng Mỹ hay bỏ /t/: "wi-nơr".

• Khi thương lượng, nhấn vào con số và điều kiện: meet halfway at FIVE, provided that the BOILER…
• Câu đề xuất "What if…?", "Could we…?" lên giọng nhẹ ở cuối để nghe mềm mỏng, còn chỗ để bàn.
• "that" trong "provided that" đọc nhẹ /ðət/, có thể bỏ hẳn: provided the boiler…
• Giọng Anh đọc half, rather với /ɑː/ ("haaf", "raa-đơ"); giọng Mỹ đọc /æ/ ("hép", "re-đơr").

Grammar Focus

Đưa đề xuất: What if…? / meet halfway

"What if + quá khứ đơn?" đưa ra đề xuất một cách thăm dò, mềm hơn dùng hiện tại đơn. "meet (someone) halfway" là mỗi bên nhượng bộ một nửa.

What if we **paid** in two parts?
What if I **worked** from home on Fridays?
You say fifty, I say thirty. **Shall we meet halfway**?

Đặt điều kiện: provided that / as long as

Cả hai nghĩa là "với điều kiện là", theo sau là hiện tại đơn dù nói về tương lai. "provided (that)" trang trọng hơn "as long as".

You can borrow it, **as long as** you **bring** it back.
We'll deliver free, **provided that** you **order** before noon.

Role Play track 27

A: Lam, I'm afraid I'll have to raise your rent by ten percent next year.

B: Ten percent? That's quite steep. What if I _____ instead?

A: That would help. I could probably do seven, then.

B: I was rather hoping for three. Could we _____ at five?

A: You drive a hard bargain! Five it is, as long as you mow the lawn.

B: Happy to, provided that _____ before winter.

A: That's reasonable. I'll have it looked at on Monday.

B: Brilliant. Then I think we've got a deal.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. What if I signed for two years instead?
   a. paid six months upfront
   b. signed a longer lease
   c. did some repairs myself

2. Could we meet halfway at five?
   a. settle
   b. compromise
   c. meet in the middle

3. Happy to, provided that the boiler gets fixed before winter.
   a. the heating is sorted
   b. you fix the windows
   c. the roof is repaired